

Maria Echevarria, CPA

STRENGTHS

- **Analytical Appitude**
Financial Analysis, 25+ years of experience Analyzing financial statements, identifying trends and providing recommendations
- **Innovation Management**
Process improvements, led teams in reducing financial processing time by 50% through the implementation of automation and optimizing techniques
- **Budget Management**
Managed approved budget, ensuring all expenses were within the allocated amount and identifying areas for cost-saving opportunities

SKILLS

Financial Planning. Forecasting. Accounting & Finance. Risk Assessment. Leadership. Strategic Mindset
Communication and Collaboration
Business Intelligence

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Cross-functional Collaboration
Collaborated with cross-functional teams to develop and implement Budget Monitoring System (BMS) and Purchase Requisition System (PRS), resulting in increase efficiency and accuracy

OTHERS

- Bachelor of Accountancy – St Paul College QC
- Certified Public Accountant
06 June 1990 Reg#83141
- ACCA Diploma in Accounting & Business
03 December 2018 Reg#4104394
- ACPACI Member
- PICPA Member

Mobile Number: +63 09604342042
Email: echevarria.ase@yahoo.com
Linkdin.com/in/maria-e-a9b20262



SUMMARY

37 years of relevant progressive work experience since 1990 in various industries (Retail, Distribution, Pawnshop, Remittance Construction), a Key Member of the Management team. I am a perfect fit for a company that seeks a seasoned professional with the ability to work as a business partner with top management and offer financial guidance to be on the right track of success in achieving their goals.

14 years of Senior Manager Level since year 1998 and 13 years of as Accounting Head, Finance/Comptroller (Vice President Level).

Previously assigned role as Investor Relation Officer at IRemit, Inc.

WORK BACKGROUND

DEC2024-MAY2025 * FINANCE DIRECTOR * JS UNITRADE

Group Finance Director of several companies (FMCG, Hotel and Leasing)

JUN2022-NOV2024 * VP COMPTROLLER * IREMIT, INC.

Handles the Group Finance Division (Manila Office & Foreign Office)

JUN2021-JUN2022 * ACCOUNTING HEAD * KBMC (KYOWA) Handles Accounts Receivable and Credit & Collection. NS Oracle

APR2016-DEC2020 * ACCOUNTING HEAD * SINAG PAWNSHOP Group Finance Division (15 companies), set up ERP (NAV), author of Policies and Procedures Manual.

JUL2016-DEC2016 * VP COMPTROLLER* MAGUINDANAO DIST

Handles Nestle Distributor & Trucking Business in Mindanao

APR2015 – JUL2015 * ACCOUNTING HEAD * LAWSON PHILS

Set up of the ERP NAV, development of Policies and Procedures, Financial reporting, Payables, Receivables, Tax compliance

SEP2012 – OCT2014 * VP FINANCE * RICHWELL PHILIPPINES

Companies related to toys, shoes, toys, baby products, apparels and module contractors

JUL2008-SEP2012 * SENIOR ACCOUNTING MANAGER * SM RETAIL

Opening Team: Set up and Training (Accounting Dept) SM Branches: Marikina, Naga, Rosario, Tarlac, Calamba, Masinag, Olongapo, Novaliches, General Santos, Baliwag, San Pablo and San Fernando

MAY1998-JUN2008 * REGIONAL ACCOUNTING MANAGER * SM RETAIL

Handles Central 2 (Manila Area): SM Quiapo, SM Manila, SM San Lazaro, SM Sta. Mesa and SM Harrison

JUN1995-MAY1998 * SENIOR ANALYST * SM RETAIL

Handles SM Department store Semi-Annual Budget preparation and monthly monitoring of SM Department store assigned

MAY1991-JUN1995 * ACCOUNTING SUPRVISOR * VIDEO CITY

Accountant handles the General Accounting books of account

JAN1991-MAY1991 * INTERNAL AUDITOR * JAG JEANS

Monitors physical inventory and tagging of the Fixed Assets of the company

PROGRESSIVE WORK EXPERIENCE

STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP AND TEAM MANAGEMENT

- Collaborate with executive management to determine strategic direction
- Champion and promote the organization's vision, mission, and value
- Organize the department in terms of resources and processes
- Ensure the resources are in place to support a high-value environment
- Take overall accountability for ensuring the team commits to meet defined service level agreements and in compliance to all organizational policies procedures and programs
- Oversee recruiting, hiring and training of staff by providing support and resources to ensure performance feedback system is in place and developmental plans are carried out.
- Align department's and team's objectives with organizational and customer objectives and in support of organization's vision, mission, and values
- Motivate the team to achieve individual & team goals by setting performance objectives & standards, monitoring, evaluating and discussing performance. Conduct performance reviews and administer rewards

SYSTEMS AND POLICY DEVELOPMENT

- Design, implement and continually improve the financial system and related systems necessary to enable the company gather the information and generate reports needed to make sound business decisions
- Establish, review and improve the system ensuring Finance compliance to company policies and procedures.
- Alignment of all Finance policies and procedures based on requirements.
- Coordinate with other departments to assess internal controls, focusing on operational and efficiency

GENERAL ACCOUNTING

- Ensure timely and accurate reporting of financial information
- Analyze financial information detailing assets, liabilities and statements of operations
- Direct local statutory audit requirements with external auditors
- Provide advisory support to management such as but not limited to interpreting the budget, identifying opportunities and areas for improvement on the financial aspect, use of financial resources and assumptions underlying budgets and forecasts
- Analyze records of present and past operations, trends and costs, estimated and realized revenues, administrative commitments, and obligations incurred to project future revenues and expenses and forecasted cash working requirements

TAXES, LICENSES AND COMPLIANCE

- Oversee tax compliance matters (SSS, PHIC, HDMF, LGU's, BIR, SEC, DTI)
- Ensure accurate and timely reporting and payment of taxes
- Hands on overseeing External Audits and BIR & BSP audits

TREASURY

- Oversee cash management banking and financial institution relationship
- Implement new technologies to improve cash cycle & simplify operations
- Forecast interest expense and income

PAYROLL

- Ensure all reconciliations are completed in an accurate and timely manner o Establish and maintain short-term credit availability which includes revolving credit agreements to provide liquidity for the Company (Letter of Credit /Line Of Credit /Trust Receipt)
- Remain current on and in compliance with local legal requirements on existing and new legislation o Review payroll records and approves changes on exemptions, insurance coverage, job titles and department/division transfer

IN-HOUSE SYSTEMS AND ERP SOFTWARE

- Project in-charge of In-house developed accounting systems o Project in-charge for implementation of ERP (Oracle, NAV, ERIC)
- In charge of development of Accounting Policies and Procedures Manual and Instructional Manual for in-house developed accounting systems (automation)

TRAININGS AND SEMINARS

- Sustainability in Finance (PICPA-ACCA)
 - Climate Risk and Reporting
 - Sustainable Development Goals and Their Impact
 - ESG Performance and Metrics / Sustainability Analytics
- Annual Corporate Governance
 - AMLA Compliance in the age of the Digital World
 - Cybersecurity Governance: Challenges and Solutions
- Culture of Innovation and Beyond

Dear Sir:

In the past financial managers and executives are effective through raising capital and instituting controls. Today, to be effective one must be more than a financial manager. To be on-board, I offer expertise as a transformative change leader, strategic business partner and administrative operations manager.

I have in-depth experience in all areas of accounting and financial management. I possess excellent communication skills and I am able to convey information to key stakeholders efficiently. My expertise in finance is keen. I have the ability to find ways to maintain financial efficiency and to comply with all laws regarding finance.

However, the true value of my contribution is found in my leadership ability. A respected and inspirational leader. I put great effort into addressing the needs of all stakeholders. I thrive on challenges found in high stress situations and use a calm, analytical approach to secure commitment, trust and support from all involved.

I am a lifelong learner; I always believe in continuous growth. In addition to my Bachelor in Accountancy, Certified Public Accountant (Philippines) and ACCA Diploma in Accounting and Business credentials.

I have the background and proven capabilities to positively effect financial and operational business change to support any company strategic direction.

Respectfully,

Maria Echevarria, CPA